

MACHINE LEARNING ENGINEER

APPLIED AI & INTELLIGENT DECISIONING

01 ENGAGEMENT DETAILS

CLIENT PayPal	ENGAGEMENT W2 Contract	TENURE 18 months	WORK MODE 100% Remote	LOCATION San Jose, CA
WORK AUTHORIZATION USC • GC • Spouse EAD • OPT • STEM OPT • TN • EB-3		START September 28-Oct 10, 2026	END September, 2027	TARGET RATE \$58-\$62/hr W2

02 CORE RESPONSIBILITIES

MODEL DEVELOPMENT + DATA

- Develop and evaluate supervised machine-learning models using large transactional and behavioral datasets.
- Implement classification and regression approaches using Python and established ML frameworks.
- Evaluate models using appropriate offline metrics and business-oriented performance measures.
- Investigate false positives, false negatives, model bias and unexpected model behavior.
- Work with data engineers to obtain, clean and transform modeling data.
- Write maintainable Python code and participate in code reviews and testing.
- Support monitoring of model performance after deployment and investigate production issues.

DECISIONING + PRODUCTION

- Build feature pipelines and training datasets for predictive modeling.
- Apply tree-based models, neural-network approaches and other appropriate algorithms based on the business problem.
- Design controlled experiments to compare model versions and determine whether changes improve performance.
- Perform model diagnostics and explain model outputs to technical and business stakeholders.
- Work with software engineers to integrate models into production services and workflows.
- Document model assumptions, experiments, validation results and deployment considerations.
- Contribute to emerging AI/ML initiatives where predictive models, automation or intelligent decisioning can improve customer or business outcomes.

03 QUALIFICATION MATRIX

REQUIRED / FOUNDATION

- Master's or Bachelor's degree in Computer Science, Data Science, Statistics, Mathematics, Engineering or a closely related quantitative field.
- Demonstrated hands-on machine-learning experience through professional, internship or graduate-level project work.
- Strong Python programming skills.
- Strong understanding of supervised learning and model evaluation.
- Experience with Scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, XGBoost or comparable frameworks.

REQUIRED / APPLIED

- Experience with feature engineering and hyperparameter tuning.
- Working knowledge of SQL and relational data.
- Understanding of classification metrics including ROC-AUC, precision, recall and related trade-offs.
- Ability to communicate technical findings clearly to engineers, data scientists and non-technical stakeholders.
- Familiarity with Git and collaborative software-development practices.

04 GOOD TO HAVE

PAYMENTS / ML DEPTH

- Fraud, credit risk, payments, financial services or transaction-data experience.
- Experience with neural networks, including CNN, LSTM or GRU architectures.
- Exposure to model deployment, monitoring or MLOps.

MODERN AI / PRODUCTION

- Experience with explainability techniques such as SHAP.
- A/B testing or hypothesis-testing experience.
- Experience working with high-volume or highly imbalanced datasets.
- Exposure to generative AI, AI agents or modern LLM-based systems.

05 EVALUATION SEQUENCE

- Coding / Data Exercise/ ML Engineering Discussion
- Behavioral / Cross-Functional
- Onboarding